

HIRING THOUGHTS

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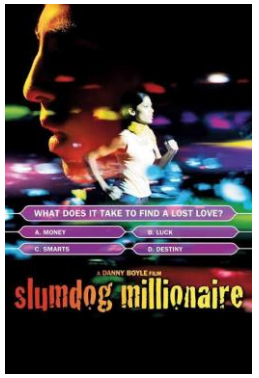
Agenda

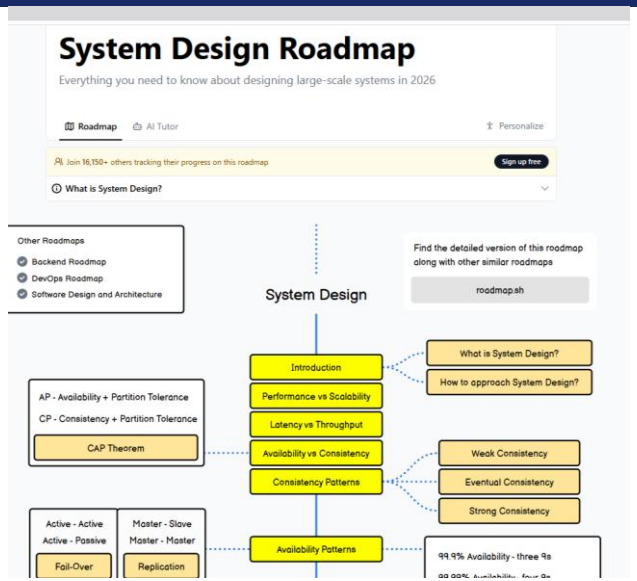
1. What are you looking for ?
2. CV/Resumé preparation
3. Hiring process on a talent outsourcing company
4. What is an interview and its advantages
5. Tech Interview Process
6. Cheating Detection
7. Soft Skills
8. Hard Skills
9. Current Trends

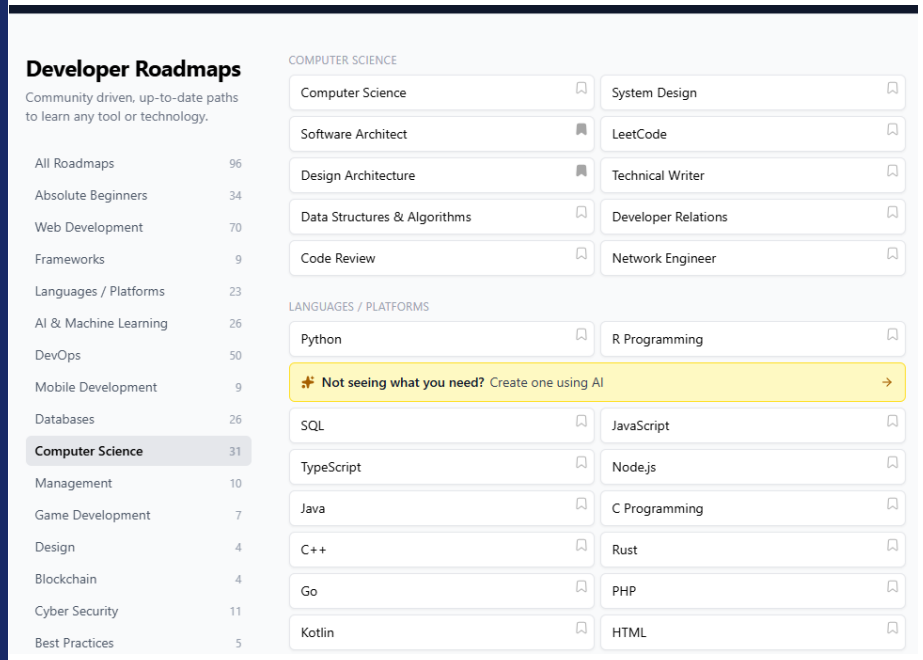
What are you looking for ?

What are you looking for in a work experience?
Match competencies with opportunities (work, academic, volunteer, or entrepreneurial).
Create your plan: steps, resources, artifacts and deadlines

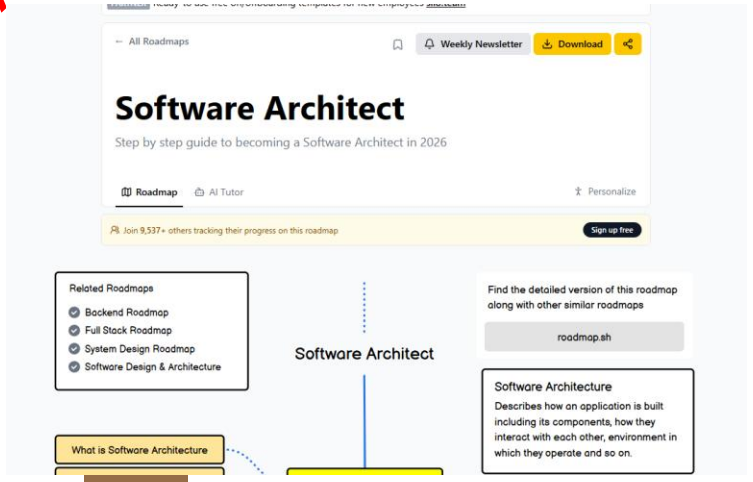
Fine-tune your plan: Life is a tragicomedy (Slumdog Millionaire)!







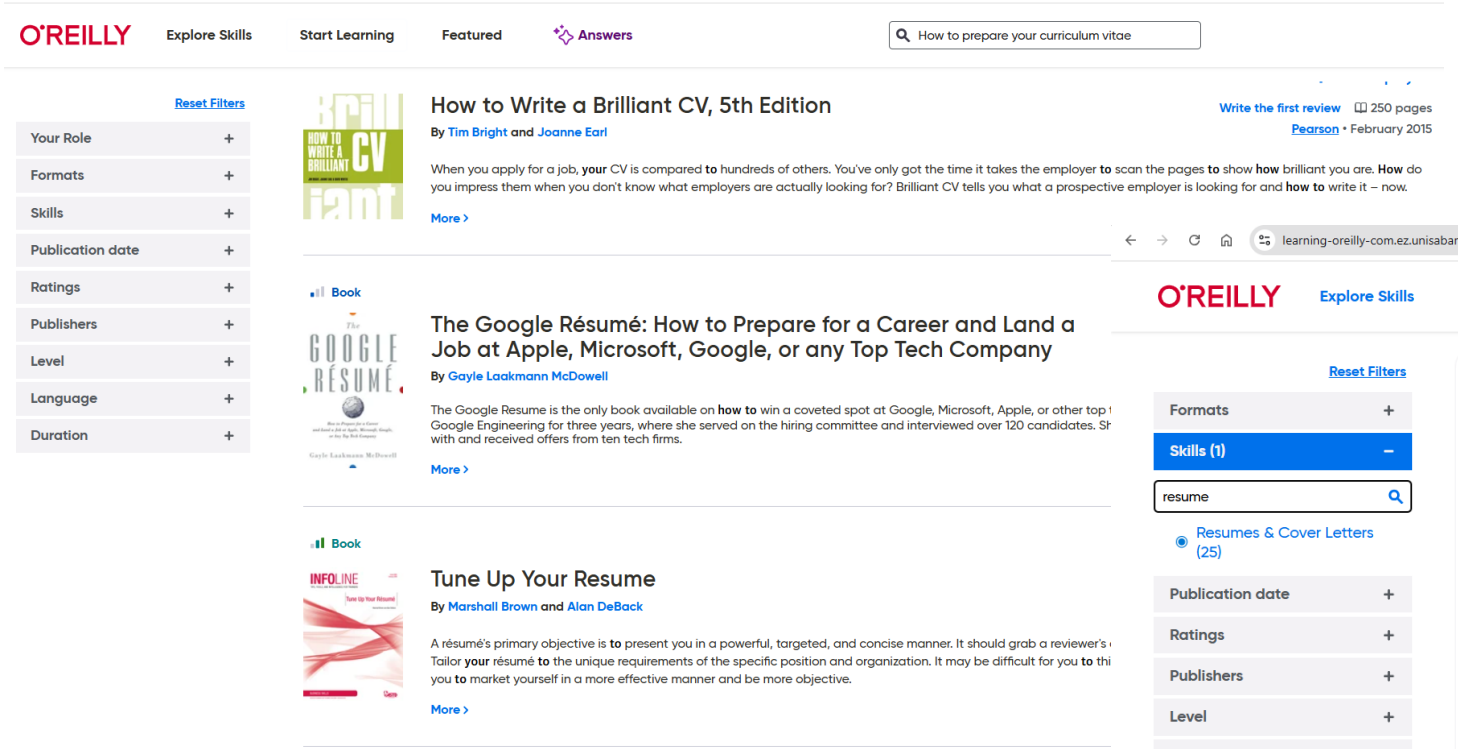
¡¡¡ YOU HAVE TIME !!!

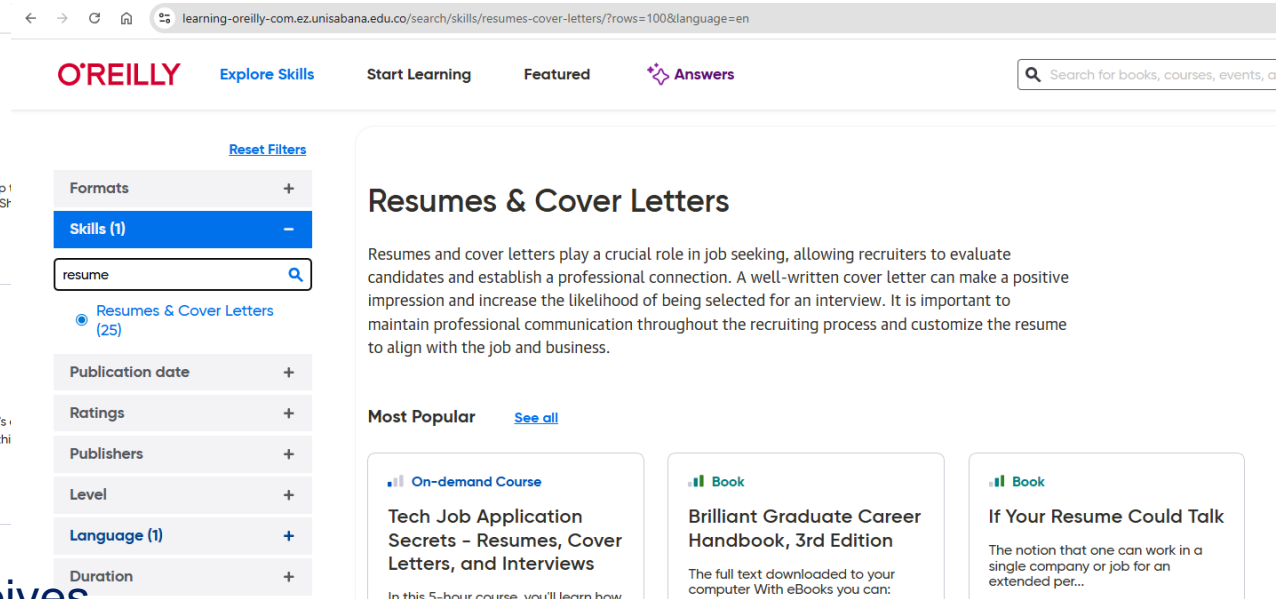


Understand abstract concepts first, then the specific tool (commercial or open-source)—e.g., transitioning cloud skills from AWS to Azure.

{Detailed presentation by a student later}

CV & Resume Resources

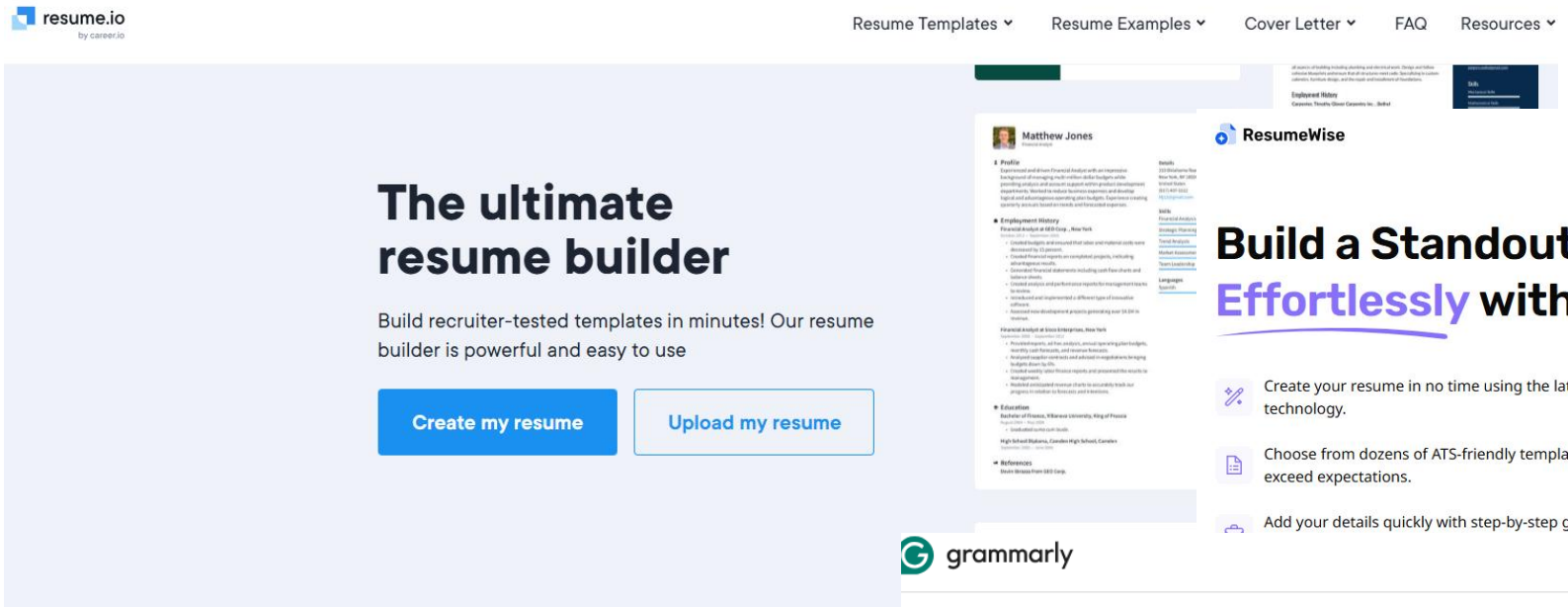


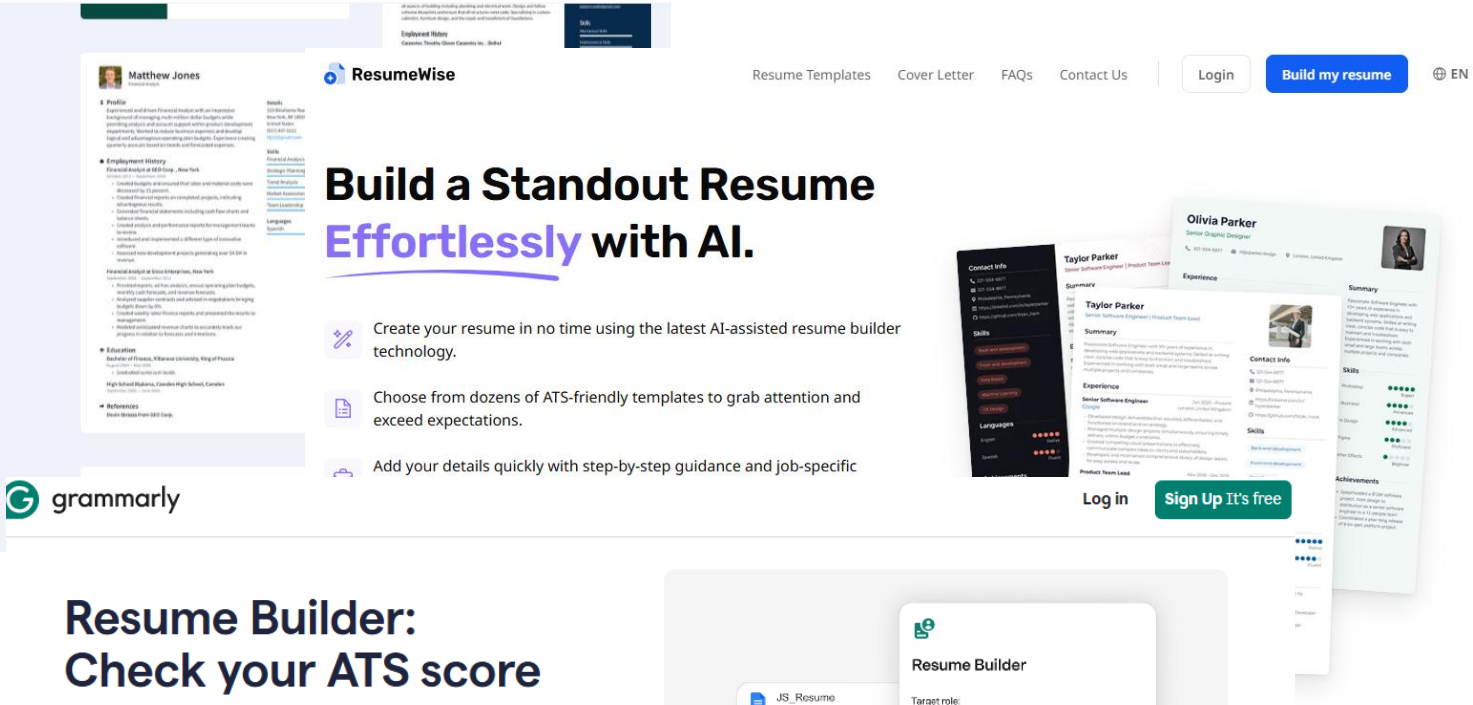


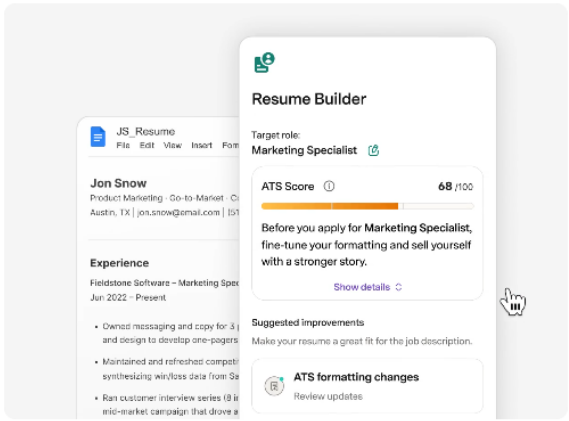
Overestimating the resume and the attention it receives.
Overestimating the qualifications of those reading your resume.
Distracting resume formats.
Avoid "one-size-fits-all" (maintain multiple tailored versions).

CV Preparation

Applicant Tracking Systems (ATS)







What is the purpose of a résumé ?

To secure an interview

CV Preparation

Competencies

Knowledge acquired through education and training

Intellectual Disposition
Commitment
Creativity
Curiosity
Enthusiasm
Imagination
Predisposition for Discovery
Sympathy/Empathy

Intellectual Maturity
Analysis
Assimilation of Information
Communication
Conceptualization
Critical Judgment
Cultural Perspective
Decision Making

Intellectual Maturity *continued*
Discrimination
Interpersonal
Nominalization
Problem Solving

Example B: committed to consensus in policy decisions; effective utilization of mathematical and quantitative reasoning in marketing strategies; enthusiastic development of profits; employment of state-of-the-art communication techniques to interpersonal interactions

Skills

Practical ability and execution level

- Information Processing
  Select
  Interpret
  Store
  Place Information into a Larger Context
- Observation
- Research
- Analysis
- Organization
- Problem Solving
- Logical Reasoning
- Historical Method
- Scientific Method
- Stimulated Listening
- Rhetorical Style
- Evaluation
- Improvisation
- Conceptualization
- Counseling Theories
- Advising
- Decision Making
- Evaluation
- Negotiation Strategies
- Argumentation

Practice: Give me the keywords for:
- **Developer**
- **DevOps**
- **Architect**
- **AI Engineer**

Depth

Depth / Proficiency Level

Where?

accurate (in)
adept (in, at)
advanced (knowledge of)
alert (in)
competent
concise
conversant (in)
detailed (knowledge of)
effective (in)
empathy
exceptional
exemplary
expert (in, at)
extraordinary
fluent (in)
functions (well)
gifted
good (at)
great
high (degree of)
intermediate (knowledge of)
judicious
keen (sense of, understanding of)
knowledge (of)
master (master of)
perception (of)
perceptive
practical (experience in)
proficient (in)
relentless (in pursuit of)
rudimentary
sensitive (to)
skilled (at, in)
sophisticated (understanding of)
strong (sense of, background in)
successful (in, at)
uncommon
understanding (of)
unusual
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

Jackson, A. L., & Geckeis, K. (2003). *How to prepare your curriculum vitae* (Revised ed.). McGraw-Hill.

CV Preparation

Structure

- Professional/Career/Vocational/Research Objectives
- Education
- Coursework
- Honors/Achievements/Awards/Kudos
- Thesis/Dissertation Abstract
- Research Interests
- Research and/or Laboratory Experience
- Teaching Interests and Experience
- Instrumentation Experience
- Specialized Skills
- Publications/Presentations/Works-in-Progress
- Work Experience
- Professional Associations/Learned/Scientific Societies
- Background
- Community Service
- Cocurricular Activities
- Interests
- Travel
- References/Letters of Recommendation

Sections can be omitted, but the organization should depend on your focus.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

FORD FOUNDATION, Lagos, Nigeria 1991
Trained and monitored 300 rural women to enhance development potential of their indigenous association; formed Abo Umulolo Women's Cooperative as forum for installing motorised engines for cracking palm kernels and milling maze, beans, and cassava

UNICEF, Imo, Nigeria
Research Consultant 1990 Monitored and evaluated impact of participatory approach to Rural Drinking Water Supply and Sanitation Project

Jackson, A. L., & Geckeis, K. (2003). *How to prepare your curriculum vitae* (Revised ed.). McGraw-Hill.

Chemistry

CV

CLEMENTINE OPHELIA HARE

2 Quackenbush Lane
Tuscaloosa, AL 34586
(205) 555-5660
E-mail: cohare@hotmail.com

Newcomb College
Box TU 6071
New Orleans, LA 70118
(504) 555-2777

PROFESSIONAL/CAREER/RESEARCH OBJECTIVE

A research position that requires background in organic synthesis and/or chemical identification through spectrographic techniques such as NMR, GC, IR, UV-Vis, and mass spectroscopy

EDUCATION

B.S., 1996, Newcomb College of Tulane University, New Orleans, LA; major in chemistry; GPA 3.3; cumulative GPA 3.2

1993–1994, University of Tennessee, Knoxville, TN

Summer 1992, University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL; studied biochemistry and environmental geology

COURSEWORK

(*denotes courses taken at the University of Tennessee)

Introductory Chemistry I*, II*
Organic Chemistry I*, II*, III
Advanced Organic Chemistry
Physical Chemistry I, II
Advanced Inorganic Chemistry
Independent Research in Chemistry
Senior Research in Chemistry

Instrumental Methods
Calculus I*, II
Physics I, II
Biology I*, II*
Environmental Hazards
Natural Hazards
Environmental Geology and Natural Resources

Related courses: Intermediate Louisiana French
Cajun Art and Music of the Nineteenth Century
Roots of Western Civilization
The Modern Experience in the West
Mass Media, Mass Society, and the Individual

LABORATORY EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Chemistry Department, Newcomb College
Under Dr. M. P. Norris, Spring 1996–Fall 1996
Experimented with synthesis of B-amino ketones via enol boronates, as they pertain to natural products

Research Assistant, Chemistry Department, Newcomb College
Under Dr. M. P. Norris, 1995–1996
Experimented with SmI selective bond cleavage of carbon-oxygen single bonds

Research Assistant, Chemistry Department, University of Tennessee
Under Dr. Craig Barnes, Summer 1994
Synthesis of macro-cycle containing two transition metal atoms

Research Assistant, Chemistry Department, University of Tennessee
Under Dr. Craig Barnes, Spring 1994, Fall 1994
Synthesis of starting material for graduate student research

INSTRUMENTATION EXPERIENCE

- Nuclear Magnetic Resonance
- Infrared and Ramen Spectroscopy
- Ultraviolet and Visible Absorption Spectroscopy
- Mass Spectrometry
- Atomic Absorption Spectrometry
- High Performance Liquid Chromatography
- Gas Chromatography
- Fluorimetry
- Gel Electrophoresis

MEMBERSHIP

Younger Chemists, American Chemical Society 1996

HONORS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

Stella Florence Pettypiece Memorial Prize in chemistry for outstanding performance in first year chemistry 1992

Clarence Charles Zess Mathematics Prize for Excellence in Calculus II

Captain, National Championship Swim Team 1991

All-America, high school swimming 1990, 1991

Deborah Wingert Athletic Scholarship (swimming), University of Tennessee 1992–1994

COCURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Varsity Swim Team, Tulane University 1994–1996

Varsity Swim Team, University of Tennessee 1993–1994

Big Brother/Big Sister, Newcomb College of Tulane University 1994–1996

Tutor, Chemistry Department, Newcomb College of Tulane University, Fall 1995; assisted students in Advanced Organic Chemistry

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Assistant to the Manager, Welsch Electric Co., Tuscaloosa, AL

Coordinated warehouse inventory with showroom inventory, Summer 1996

Coach, Tuscaloosa Swim Club, Tuscaloosa, AL, Summer 1995

Coach, United Swimming Clinics, Mercersburg, PA, Summers 1993, 1994

What is relevant?

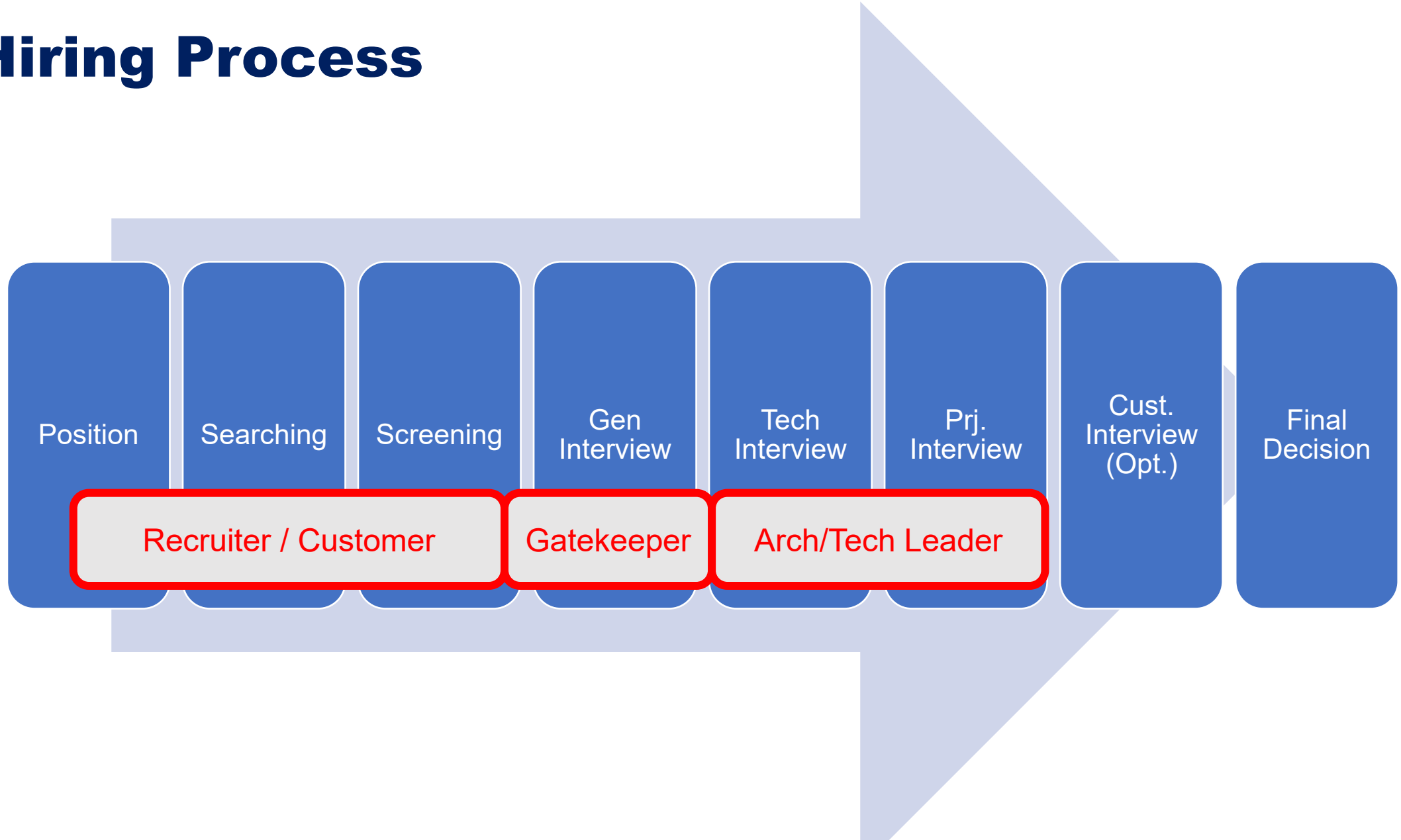
Why is this important?

Jackson, A

Subjects: Kubernetes, Best Practices, IaC
Align with skills in high demand across the industry.

Reviewing Student CVs

Hiring Process



Interview

A sales process where you pitch your time (as a recent graduate) and skills (even with little prior experience).

Assess motivation, trajectory, and growth potential.

You like to establish rapport easily; however you cannot define interviewer personality neither know if that counts on the filter.



Interview Process

-From the Interviewer's Perspective-



Preparation

- Preparation
- Interview itself
- Feedback

- Review CV.
- Review opportunity
- Additional elements: GitHub, Portfolio, Articles.
- Previous feedback.
- Determine the required candidate level: review minimum required hard skills.
- Prepare evaluation tasks and allocate interview time.

Interview

- Preparation
- Interview itself
- Feedback

- Introduce yourself and create warm atmosphere
- Explain interview steps
- Check : Candidate experience (CV)
- Check: Technologies used
- Check: Motivations
- Review: Soft and Hard Skills
- Review: Tech Questions/Code Tasks
- Review: List of min. hard skills
- Q & A
- Explain the next steps

Interview

- Preparation
- Interview itself
- Feedback

- Complete internal evaluation forms
- Maintain a constructive and polite tone

General Interview Guidelines

Record the session

Time-Bound Interview

Set clear expectations while maintaining a supportive tone.

- Prioritize required skills: level and opportunity
- Customize questions according to the role and expected level
- Use practical tasks for in-depth assessment and ask follow-up questions.
- Limit questions.

Cheating Detection

Review the candidate's job history.

Don’t accuse. Your job is to report, no to confront!

Try to finish the interview earlier in a polite way.

Check:

- camera on all the times.
- face and hands are visible on camera (listen for silent typing).
- eye contact
- body language
- hardware problems
- connectivity issues

Soft Skills

- Adaptability to learn
- Communication
- Critical Thinking
- Leadership
- Responsibility
- Stress management
- Problem-Solving
- Reliability and Teamwork

- If a candidate has been using the same technology stack or performed the same duties for more than 4-5 years, ask what the reason was.
- Ask if the candidate started to learn anything new, whose initiative it was, and what the reason was for that.

Pay attention to the following:

- The candidate's articulation and representation of the idea.
- The candidate's behavior during a call.
- The clarification questions that the candidate asks.

When a candidate describes the project:

- Ask if there are any processes that the candidate can improve. If so, ask what they can suggest or have suggested.
- Ask if the candidate has ever suggested any improvements to any projects and if they worked.

- Ask about the candidate's experience in solving conflicts or any problematic situations.

- How the candidate speaks about their company, team, project, customer, and so on, whether they blame them without any grounded reason.
- How the candidate makes estimations and behaves if the estimations are wrong.
- How does the candidate plan to transfer their duties when changing the job; how much time it will take and why.

Tell me a story about ….

Show me how to use …. skills on your previous job or hobbies

How to apply….

How to learn….

A time, when you hope to have ….. skill, however you can't do it in that way.

Soft Skills

Classification of questions:

Resume-based questions

Behavioral questions

Situational questions

Open questions

Probing questions

Leading questions

Funnel questions

- Tell us about a project or situation where you felt that the conventional approach would not be suitable. How did you derive and manage a new approach? Which challenges did you face and how did you address them?
- Why did you consider your idea to be more effective than traditional practice?
- How do you define creativity in your work?
- Describe a time when you anticipated potential problems and developed preventive measures
- Give me an example of when you were responsible for an error and which was your solution?
- When has your morale been the highest at work? Why?
- Describe a time when you had to make a difficult choice between your personal and professional life.
- Describe a time when you created a strategy to achieve a longer-term department objective.
- Tell me about a time you were approached by an irate customer, coworker, or individual. What was your response?
- Have you ever asked for forgiveness for doing something wrong in your job?
- When have you ever gone out on a limb to defend a customer? What happened?
- Tell me about a time you have “inherited” a customer. What steps did you take to establish rapport with them? What did you do to gain their trust?

Tech Skills

Trending tools/technologies

Knowledge

Something that you are learn

- CV-based Questions
- Situational questions: Scenarios

- Tech Questions, depends on the depth
- Practical Tasks, to be solved on 10-20 mins with shared screen.
- Controlled time and if you see it digress the task, keep it to the feedback.
- Code Tasks, limited tasks in a running environment, i.e. coderank.

I focus on problem-solving strategy and analytical thinking over getting an exact answer.
Other interviewers may prioritize syntax memorization.

Outsourcing Company, DevOps Practice

Terraform

Python, Bash, Go, Powershell, UNIX shell scripting

Kubernetes, Helm(12), EKS(14), Docker

AWS (4), Azure (14), GCP (11),

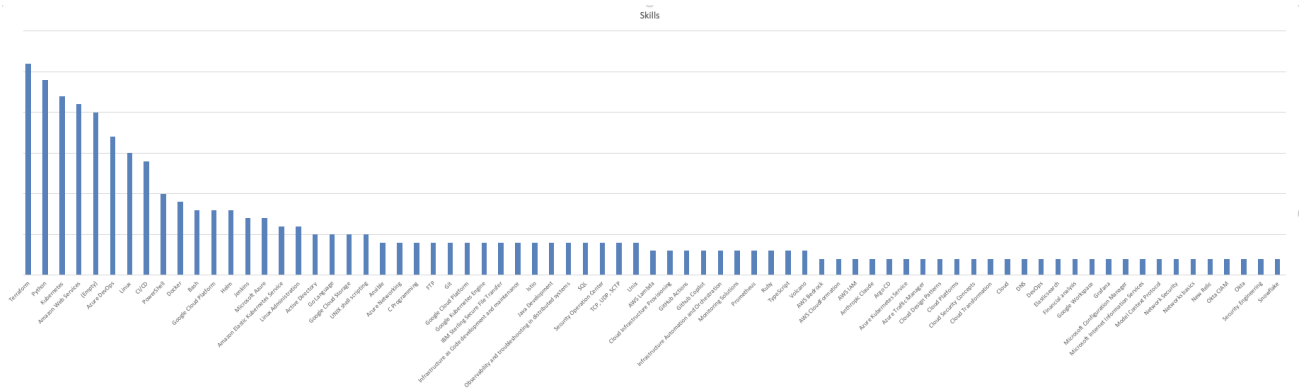
CI/CD (9), Azure DevOps (5), Jenkins (13),

Linux, Admin (16)

Active Directory

Ansible

C Programming



Outsourcing Company, AWS Practice

Terraform

Kubernetes

CI/CD

Python

AWS

	Grand Total	Terraform	Kubernetes	Azure DevOps	Python	Amazon Web Services
Grand Total	**46**	**18**	**17**	**14**	**13**	**12**
> Microsoft Azure	10	4	5	9	1	
> DevOps	9	6	5	3	5	4
> Support.Infrastructure	7				1	
> Site Reliability Engineering	6	5	5	1	4	6
> Amazon Web Services	5	3	1	1	1	2
> Security.Operations	4				1	
> Google Cloud Platform	2		1			
> Security.Testing	2					
> Application Support	1					

Other sources

- Drawn-out process → Low hiring probability
- Overly complex test tasks → Risk of unpaid work
- IMHO: Research the company and employees before submitting your resume
- Vague or confusing contracts → Potential scam
- Job post wording → Highlights key filters you must pass
- Set up job alerts matching your profile

